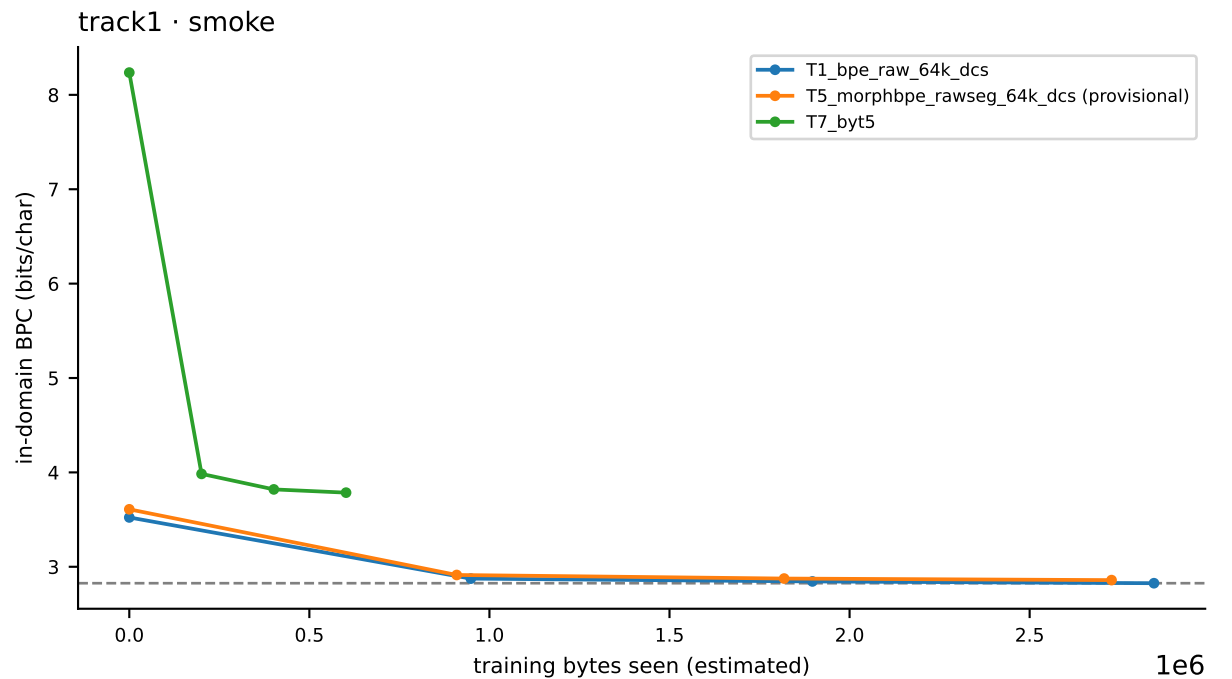


Experiment 05 — bits per character against training bytes, mean $\pm$ sd over seeds



Dashed line: the reference arm's best in-domain BPC, the level the crossings are timed against. Split arms predict the `\_split` twin of the held-out set (same sentences, ~6% more characters) but are scored per character of the RAW twin, so every arm's denominator is the same. Perplexity is never compared (CLAUDE.md §2.2).